MIL-C-36260B
3 August 1987
Superseding
MIL-C-36260A
14 February 1973

MILITARY SPECIFICATION

CASE, DENTAL INSTRUMENTS (Sterilizing and Storage)

This specification is approved for use by all Departments and Agencies of the Department of Defense.

1. SCOPE

1.1 Scope. This specification covers a dental instrument case suitable for holding and autoclaving endodontic instruments.

2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

2.1 Government documents.

2.1.1 Specifications and standards. The following specifications and standards form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein. Unless otherwise specified, the issues of these documents are those listed in the issue of the Department of Defense Index of Specifications and Standards (DoDISS) and supplement thereto, cited in the solicitation.

AMSC N/A FSC 6520

Beneficial comments (recommendations, additions, deletions) and any pertinent data which may be of use in improving this document should be addressed to: Defense Personnel Support Center, Directorate of Medical Materiel, DPSC-RSTS, 2800 South 20th Street, Philadelphia, PA 19101, by using the self-addressed Standardization Document Improvement Proposal (DD Form 1426) appearing at the end of this document or by letter.

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SPECIFICATIONS

Federal

GG-I-526	Instruments, Dental and Surgical; General Specification.
PPP-B-566	Boxes, Wood, Paperboard.
PPP-B-601	Boxes, Wood, Cleated-plywood.
PPP-B-621	Boxes, Wood, Nailed and Lock-corner.
PPP-B-636	Boxes, Fiberboard.
PPP-B-676	Boxes, Setup.

Military

MIL-L-10547	Liners, Case, and Sheet, Overwrap; Water-Vaporproof or Waterproof, Flexible.

STANDARDS

Federal

FED-STD-66	Steel, Chemical Composition and Hardenability.
FED-STD-151	Metal, Test Methods.
FED-STD-376	Preferred Metric units for general use by the Federal Government.

Military

MIL-STD-105	Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes.
MIL-STD-129	Marking for Shipment and Storage.
MIL-STD-147	Palletized Unit Loads.
MIL-STD-794	Parts and Equipment, Procedures for Packaging of.

DRAWING

Defense Personnel Support Center (DPSC)

23377	Case, Dental Instruments

(Copies of specifications, standards, and drawings required by contractors in connection with specific acquisition functions should be obtained from the contracting activity or as directed by the contracting activity).

2.2 Order of precedence. In the event of a conflict between the text of this specification and the references cited herein, the text of this specification takes precedence. Nothing in this specification, however, supersedes applicable laws and regulations unless a specific exemption has been obtained.

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3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 General requirements. The dental case shall be in accordance with the applicable requirements of GG-I-526, with the options and additional requirements specified herein.

3.2 Material. The dental instrument case shall be fabricated of AISI type 304, except the hinges may be of 302 or 304 corrosion-resisting steel in conformance with the chemical composition of FED-STD-66.

3.3 Style, design, and dimensions. The dental case shall be suitable for holding and autoclaving instruments utilized in endodontic procedures and maintaining them under aseptic conditions. The dental case shall be a compartmented instrument case consisting of 68 small compartments and one large compartment with a cover, hinges and latch. The dental case shall be fastened by means of a hinge. The hinge shall permit the lid and the case to mate with a snug fit so as to permit proper alignment of the latch for opening and closure. The style, design and dimensions of the dental case shall conform to Defense Personnel Support Center (DPSC) Drawing 23377.

3.4 Welding. All welds shall be durable and sound. Welds shall be clean, smooth, free of pits, cracks, or foreign matter. All welding shall be done with appropriate equipment properly regulated and operated by thoroughly trained and experienced welders, highly skilled in the operations of stainless steel welding.

3.5 Autoclave test. The dental instrument case, in its entirety, shall be properly passivated and shall show no signs of corrosion when tested as specified in 4.3.2.

3.6 Finish. The dental instrument case (all sheet metal surfaces) shall have a smooth satin finish. All finishes shall be uniform except for necessary sound weld marks on the bottom surface of the case. The rivets, hinges and latches shall have a uniform satin or polished finish.

3.7 Identification marking. Each dental instrument case shall be permanently and legibly stamped or etched with the name or registered trademark of the manufacturer.

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3.8 Workmanship. All components of the case shall fit into their respective position. Components, such as hinges, and latches shall operate smoothly and be properly aligned. The cover shall have a flush type fit when closed. All surfaces, edges and corners shall be free from sharp edges, distortion or dents. The case (top cover) shall be free of welding and solder marks. The case shall be free from flaws and defects which detract from their appearance or may impair their serviceability.

4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS

4.1 Responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the contractor is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified in the contract or order, the contractor may use his own or any other facilities suitable for the performance of the inspection requirements specified herein, unless disapproved by the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to ensure supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

4.1.1 Records. Records of examinations and tests performed by or for the contractor shall be maintained by the contractor and made available to the Government, upon the Government's request, at any time, or from time to time, during the performance of the contract and for a period of three years after delivery of the supplies to which such records relate.

4.1.2 Inspection. Inspection, as used in this specification, is defined as both examination (such as visual or auditory investigation without the use of special laboratory appliances or procedures) and testing (determination by technical means of physical and chemical properties) of the item.

4.1.3 Certificates of quality. Certificates of quality, supplied by the manufacturer of the material, may be furnished in lieu of actual performance of such testing by the contractor, provided lot identity has been maintained and can be demonstrated to the Government. The Certificate shall include the name of the contractor, the contract number, the name of the manufacturer or supplier, the NSN, the Item Identification, the name of the material, the lot number, the lot size, the sample size, the date of testing, the test method, individual test results, and the specification requirements.

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4.1.4 Metric products. Products manufactured to metric dimensions will be considered on an equal basis with those manufactured using inch/pound units, providing they fall within the tolerances specified using conversion tables contained in the latest revision of Federal Standard No. 376, and all other requirements of this document are met.

If a product is manufactured to metric dimensions and those dimensions exceed the tolerances specified in the inch/pound units, a request should be made to the contracting officer to determine if the product is acceptable.

The contracting officer has the option of accepting or rejecting the product.

4.2 Quality conformance inspection. Quality conformance inspection shall consist of all examinations specified in 4.2.2, and all testing specified in 4.3, and shall apply to those samples selected in accordance with 4.2.1 and 4.2.3. Quality conformance inspection shall be performed by the supplier in accordance with 4.1.

4.2.1 Sampling for examination. Sampling for examination shall be conducted in accordance with MIL-STD-105. The inspection levels and acceptable quality levels (AQLs) shall be as indicated in Table I. Unit of product for examination purposes shall be one complete dental instrument case.

TABLE I. Inspection and acceptable quality levels

Type defect	Inspection level	AQL (percent defective)
For visual examination		
Major	II	1.0
Minor	II	2.5
For dimensional examination	S-2	2.5

4.2.2 Examination. The complete dental case shall be examined to determine compliance with all requirements contained in the specification, and shall be examined for defects, including, but not limited to, those listed in table II.

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TABLE II. Classification of Defects

Categories	Defects
Major	
101	Style and design not as specified.
102	Case not constructed as specified.
103	Components not secured to form sound and durable construction.
104	The cover does not overlap and adequately mate with the base portion on all four sides to provide a baffle type closure.
105	The aberdeen barrel latch cannot be positioned such to hold the cover partially open for autoclaving.
106	Welds not clean, smooth, free of cracks, or foreign matter.
107	Sheet metal surfaces, edges and corners not free from sharp edges, bowing, cracks, distortion, or dents.
108	Cover not flush type fit when closed.
Minor	
201	Marking not present, not properly located, illegible, or incomplete
202	Case not free from dirt, polishing compound or foreign matter.
203	Finish not as specified.
204	Hinges and latches do not operate smoothly.

4.2.2.1 Dimensional examination. The case (all components) shall be examined for defects in dimensions. Any dimension not within the tolerance specified shall be classified as a defect.

4.2.3 Sampling for testing. Sampling for testing shall be in accordance with MIL-STD-105 and table III, except that the acceptance number shall be zero for all sample sizes. The unit of product shall be one complete dental case.

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TABLE III. Sampling and acceptance criteria for testing

Characteristic	Requirement	Test Procedure	Inspection level
Composition	3.2	4.2.1	see 4.2.3.1
Autoclave Test	3.5	4.2.2	S-1

4.2.3.1 Raw materials. Sufficient amount from each lot of each metal used in the construction of the case (all components) shall be selected for chemical analysis.

4.3. Tests. Tests shall be conducted to determine compliance with specification requirements.

4.3.1 Composition analysis. Specimens of materials used to fabricate the case, or taken from samples, shall be subjected to analysis in accordance with methods 111 or 112 of Fed. Test Method Standard No. 151. In case of dispute, method 111 shall be used for referee analysis.

4.3.2 Autoclaving. The dental case shall be cleaned and placed in an autoclave. The dental case shall then be autoclaved at 270° ± 5°F. and 27 ± 1 pounds per square inch (psi) pressure for a minimum of 20 minutes. After the dental case is removed from the autoclave, the entire surface area of the dental case shall be examined for evidence of corrosion.

4.4 Inspection of packaging. The sampling and inspection of the packing and marking for shipment and storage shall be in accordance with the quality assurance provisions of the applicable container specification and the marking requirements of MIL-STD-129.

5. PACKAGING

5.1 Preservation. Preservation shall be level A or C, as specified (see 6.1).

5.1.1 Level A.

5.1.1.1 Unit package. Each case shall be clean, dry and wrapped in kraft paper or other suitable material. Each wrapped case shall be further packaged in a box conforming to PPP-B-566, PPP-B-636, class domestic or PPP-B-676. Closure shall be as specified in the applicable box specification.

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5.1.2 Level C.

5.1.2.1 Unit package. The preservation for dental instrument cases shall conform to the requirements of MIL-STD-794 for level C.

5.2 Packing. Packing shall be level A, B or C, as specified (see 6.1).

5.2.1 Level A. Twelve unit packages containing dental instrument cases shall be packed in an exterior container designed for a type 2 load and conforming to PPP-B-601, overseas type, PPP-B-621, class 2, or PPP-B-636, class weather-resistant. Closure and strapping shall be as specified in the applicable box specification.

5.2.1.1 Case liner. Each level A wood box shall be lined with a waterproof case liner conforming to MIL-L-10547. Closure and sealing shall be as specified in the liner specification. Case liner shall not be required for fiberboard boxes. Each fiberboard box shall be waterproofed as specified in PPP-B-636.

5.2.2 Level B. Twelve unit packages containing dental instrument cases shall be packed in an exterior container designed for a type 2 load and conforming to PPP-B-601, domestic type, PPP-B-621, class 1, or PPP-B-636, class domestic. Closure shall be as specified in the applicable box specification.

5.2.3 Level C. Twelve unit packages containing dental instrument cases shall be packed in accordance with the requirements of MIL-STD-794 for level C.

5.2.4 Packing variation permitted. If the required number of units to be shipped is less than the number of units specified to be overpacked in an exterior container, such units shall be packed in an exterior container of suitable size and design, acceptable to a common carrier, which will insure safe delivery to destination.

5.2.5 Unitized loads. Unitized loads, commensurate with the level of packing specified in the contract or order, shall be used whenever total quantities for shipment to one destination exceed 250 pounds or 20 cubic feet or more. Loads shall be unitized on pallets conforming to MIL-STD-147. Quantities less than 20 cubic feet need not be unitized. Pallet loads including the pallet shall not exceed 54 inches in height, 48 inches in width, and 40 inches in length. Pallet shall conform to Type IV or Type V.

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5.2.5.1 Levels A and B. Dental instrument cases packed as specified in 5.2.1 and 5.2.2 shall be unitized on pallets as specified in 5.2.5.

5.2.5.2 Level C. Dental instrument cases packed as specified in 5.2.3 shall be unitized as specified in MIL-STD-794.

5.3 Marking.

5.3.1 Levels A, B and C. Each unit pack, exterior container and unitized load shall be marked as specified in MIL-STD-129.

5.4. General

5.4.1 Exterior container. Exterior container (see 5.2.1, 5.2.2, and 5.2.3) shall be of minimum tare and cube consistent with the protection required and shall contain equal quantities of identical stock numbered items to the greatest extent practicable.

5.4.2 Packaging inspection. The inspection of these packaging requirements shall be in accordance with 4.6.

6. NOTES

6.1 Ordering data. Acquisition documents should specify the following:

(a) Title, number, and date of this specification.
(b) Selection of applicable levels of packaging and packing (see 5.1 and 5.2).

6.2 National Stock Number (NSN) coverage. This specification covers the following item appearing in the Federal Supply Catalog:

National Stock Number	Item Identification
6520-00-890-1883	CASE, DENTAL INSTRUMENTS, Sterilizing and Storage, Corrosion-Resisting Metal.

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6.3 Subject term (key word) listing:
Case
Instrument case

MILITARY INTERESTS:

Custodians:

Army - MD
Navy - MS
Air Force - 03

Review Activities:

Army - MD
Navy - MS
Air Force - 03

Civil Agency Coordinating Activities:
VA-OSS
PHS
FDA-MPQAS

PREPARING ACTIVITY:

DoD-MB

Agent:

DLA-DM

Project No. 6520-1968

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3a. NAME OF SUBMITTING ORGANIZATION	4. TYPE OF ORGANIZATION *(Mark one)*
	☐ VENDOR ☐ USER ☐ MANUFACTURER ☐ OTHER *(Specify)*:
b. ADDRESS *(Street, City, State, ZIP Code)*	

5. PROBLEM AREAS

a. Paragraph Number and Wording:

b. Recommended Wording:

c. Reason/Rationale for Recommendation:

6. REMARKS

7a. NAME OF SUBMITTER *(Last, First, MI)* – Optional	b. WORK TELEPHONE NUMBER *(Include Area Code)* – Optional
c. MAILING ADDRESS *(Street, City, State, ZIP Code)* – Optional	8. DATE OF SUBMISSION *(YYMMDD)*

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